PENNE ALLA VODKA

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4-6	**1 h 15 min**

INGREDIENTS

624 g	Extruded penne
42 g	Olive oil
250 g	Onion, finely diced
15 g	Garlic, finely chopped
2 g	Dried red chile flakes
85 g	Tomato paste
73 g	Vodka
680 g	Tomato passata
115 g	Heavy cream
56 g	Mascarpone
quantity not given	Salt
30 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Dried red chile flakes, to finish
quantity not given	Black pepper, to finish

METHOD

1. Extrude 624 g of penne.
2. Warm the olive oil in a large sauté pan set over low heat, then cook the onion 5 to 8 minutes, until it turns translucent and still has no color.
3. Stir the garlic in for 10 to 15 seconds, just until it smells of itself, then add the chile flakes and let them bloom in the oil.
4. Add the tomato paste and keep stirring for 2 to 3 minutes, until the color darkens.
5. Pour in the vodka and cook 3 to 5 minutes, stirring now and then, until the alcohol has gone off.
6. Stir the passata through, drop the heat to low and simmer about 30 minutes, until the flavors have come together.
7. Off the heat, stir in the cream, then fold the mascarpone in gently. Season with salt.
8. Measure out 533 g of sauce for this dish. The rest goes into an airtight container and keeps in the fridge for up to 3 days.
9. Salt a large pot of water heavily, bring it to the boil over high heat and cook the penne 5 to 8 minutes, to al dente.
10. While it boils, set a large sauté pan over low heat with the reserved sauce plus 2 to 3 ladles of pasta water, 115 to 170 g, stirred together.
11. Lift the penne across with a spider or pasta basket, raise the heat to medium and toss 30 seconds to 1 minute to marry.
12. Add the butter and carry on tossing. A splash more pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens.
13. Divide into bowls and finish with the parmigiano, more chile flakes and black pepper.

NOTES

The sauce makes more than the dish needs. Only 533 g goes in, and the remainder keeps three days refrigerated.
Red chile is what keeps the sauce from reading as plain indulgence. Calabrian chiles can go in alongside the dried flakes for more heat and a deeper bass note.
Cream first and off the heat, then the mascarpone folded in gently rather than beaten through.
Give the tomato paste its full 2 to 3 minutes before the vodka goes in. The deepened color is the cue.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

_____